Gina Pagan *she/her/hers*

Agricultural and Resource Economics
University of California, Davis
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Citizenship: USA

Fields Labor Economics, Public Economics, Agricultural Economics, Economic History

Education

Ph.D., Agricultural and Resource Economics, UC Davis *expected June 2027*

B.A., Economics, Psychology, Amherst College *2018*

Job Market Paper

"Bend and SNAP? The Effect of Food Availability on Workplace Injuries" by Gina Pagan.

I leverage exogenous variation in the timing of SNAP benefit disbursal to estimate how relative food availability affects workplace injuries. SNAP recipients spend most of their benefits in the first two weeks after disbursal, and prior research shows that this pattern, known as the SNAP cycle, affects cognitive performance and health, but its effect on worker safety has not been established. Using administrative workers' compensation claims from Oregon over 2005–2018 and a predicted measure of SNAP eligibility, I find no effect when workers are pooled, but large and offsetting effects by gender among workers aged 18 to 24. Injuries for young women are highest in the first days after benefits arrive, while injury rates for young men rise in the second half of the benefit month by 17.6 percent for non-severe and 25.4 percent for severe injuries. Because severe and non-severe injuries move proportionally, these patterns are most consistent with changes in hours worked. Among men aged 45 to 54, by contrast, the rate of severe injury rises by 47 percent on the day benefits are received while non-severe injuries do not, a shift that labor supply alone would not produce. These intent-to-treat estimates likely understate effects for SNAP participants.

Work in Progress

- "Ethnicity and Agricultural Attachment in the Post-WWII Southwest," by Gina Pagan.
- "The Role of Food Assistance in Rural Areas," by Charlotte Ambrozek, Timothy Beatty, Gina Pagan, and Matthew Rabbitt.
- "Immigration Enforcement and Workplace Injury Reporting" by Gina Pagan.

Teaching Experience

Instructor, UC Davis
ARE 198: Applied Economics Research Workshop — Summer 2026

Teaching Assistant, UC Davis
ARE 150: Agricultural Labor — Fall 2025
ARE 155: Operations Research and Management Science — Summer 2025
ARE 115A: Economic Development — Spring 2022
IAD 201: Economics of Small-Scale Agriculture in Developing Countries — Winter 2021

Research Experience and Previous Employment

Graduate Student Researcher, Katherine Hauck (Economic History)	2026
Graduate Student Researcher, Tim Beatty (Public Economics)	2022-2024
Analyst, Matrix Economics	2018-2020

Fellowships, Awards, & Grants

Jastro & Shields Graduate Research Award,	2025
Center for Occupational and Environmental Health Trainee,	2023-present

Conferences

2026: WEAI Annual Conference, AAEA Annual Meeting, EHA Annual Meeting
2024: AAEA Annual Meeting

Languages

R; Stata; Python

References

Prof. Tim Beatty (chair)
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